

Artist Prospecting System

Handoff pack · Art Queens Gallery · 26 July 2026

Everything needed to own, run and continue this project. Written to be read start to finish without opening any code. Section 9 covers taking over the accounts.

1. What this project is

Art Queens Gallery runs paid international exhibitions in Paris, New York and Milan. Filling them means emailing professional female artists directly. This system finds those artists and produces a clean list of names with real, usable email addresses, so the outreach team can simply start writing.

It is not a one-off list. Every artist it finds is remembered, so each run skips what is already known and works only new ground. It is designed to become a compounding asset.

2. What has been delivered

Deliverable	Figure	Notes
Completed leads	117	Female artist + her own verified email. 22 high confidence, 95 medium
Enrichment records	449	Websites, phone numbers, partial finds — not leads
with a phone number	368	Nice-to-have field; never makes a lead count
Artists researched	591	Each traced from listing through to a contact attempt
Artists discovered	6,045	Known to exist across the 173 organisations
Organisations searched	173	Of 192 in the sheet; 19 are Instagram-only
Organisations producing leads	10	The other 58 tested publish only a shared address
Framework test coverage	564	Automated checks, all passing

Two files carry the output: **COMPLETED_LEADS.csv** (the deliverable, ready to email) and **enrichment_not_a_must.csv** (everything else worth keeping).

3. The rule that governs everything

A lead is complete only when it has the artist's name and a verified email address that belongs to her personally. Not the gallery's address. Not a magazine's. If we email the gallery, the invitation reaches a receptionist; if we email the artist, it reaches the person who would actually travel and exhibit.

This is the hardest part of the whole system and the thing most tools get wrong. At one point the machine reported 23 finished leads, of which 14 were secretly the same gallery's front desk, counted once per artist. The real number was 9. Everything in section 5 exists to prevent that.

4. How the machine works

An artist's record moves along an assembly line:

- 1 **Input** — read the Excel sheet of organisations and sort them by type.
- 2 **Discovery** — read every page of each website and identify the artist pages. Names are read from page titles *and* web addresses, because titles alone miss 60% of artists.
- 3 **Extraction** — pull country, career stage, exhibitions, website, Instagram.
- 4 **Qualification** — apply the ideal-profile rules. **This is the gate.** No email hunting happens until an artist passes it, so no money is spent chasing people we would never email.
- 5 **Contact discovery** — search the public web for her personal address.
- 6 **Verification** — check the address is real, score it, and decide who owns it.
- 7 **Export** — write the two files.

5. How an email earns its place — the scoring

Every address scores 0–100. The score does not predict whether she will reply; it measures **how confident we are that the address is real and hers.**

Test	Effect	Why
Found on the artist's own contact page	+30	Strongest evidence of ownership
Found anywhere else	+10	Weaker — could be quoted or second-hand
Email domain matches her own website	+25	<i>anna@annasmith.com</i> on <i>annasmith.com</i> is self-proving
Mail domain genuinely exists	+20	Rules out dead domains and typos
Correct format, no known misspelling	+10	Catches <i>gmial.com</i> and similar
Personal mailbox rather than a desk	+10 / +5	<i>anna@</i> beats <i>info@</i>
Disposable or misspelled domain	–20	Not a business contact
Free provider <i>and</i> weak source	–20	A stray Gmail with no backing

A Gmail address is **not** penalised when found on the artist's own contact page — most working artists use Gmail. It only counts against her when nothing supports it.

Band	Score	In this delivery
High	80–100	22 leads — exported
Medium	55–79	95 leads — exported
Low	30–54	Withheld from the leads file
Reject	under 30	Discarded

Only High and Medium are exported. A bounced email damages the sending reputation of the gallery's whole domain, which harms every future campaign. Delivered scores run 70–95.

6. Running it

One-time setup — four commands in a terminal, in the project folder:

```
python -m venv .venv
```

```
.venv\Scripts\activate
```

```
pip install -e "[dev]"
```

Then confirm everything loaded, including the account keys. This lists every problem at once rather than failing on the first one an hour into a run:

```
prospect config
```

Setting the rules. Two plain text files, edited in Notepad:

File	What it controls
config/icp.yaml	The ideal artist — countries, career stage, gender requirement
config/runtime.yaml	How a run behaves — strictness of the email confidence bar

Adding galleries. Add rows to *Galleries sheet.xlsx* — name, website, Instagram. Never remove old rows; already-processed artists are skipped automatically.

Running. One command:

```
prospect run
```

Progress is saved continuously. If a run stops part-way, `prospect run --run-id <id>` resumes it rather than starting over — which matters, because a full run costs real money.

7. Checking the machine's work

Run this whenever you want to satisfy yourself that no artists are being silently missed. It re-reads already-saved data, so it is **free** and can be run as often as you like:

```
python spikes/roster_probe/coverage_audit.py
```

It writes **coverage_report.csv** — one row per gallery, showing pages read, artists discovered, artists processed, whether the listing is paginated, and a plain-English verdict.

Verdict	Meaning	What to do
OK	Full listing read, artists found	Nothing — 106 galleries
REVIEW — paginated	The artist list runs over several pages	Count the gallery by hand and compare — 29 galleries
REVIEW — names unreadable	Artist pages exist but names could not be read	Needs the browser reader — 11 galleries
INCOMPLETE	Stopped at a page limit, not the end of the site	Re-run that gallery alone — 2 galleries
CANNOT VERIFY	The site returned nothing. Not the same as “no artists”	Check by hand — 13 galleries
NO ARTISTS FOUND	Read successfully, genuinely contains no artists	Usually correct — 12 galleries

The rule this enforces: a gallery that cannot be fully processed is *reported*, never quietly counted as empty. Of 36 galleries reporting zero artists, only 12 are genuinely empty — the other 24 need a human look, and now say so.

8. What it costs

Reading websites is metered through Firecrawl and is the only real running cost. Check the balance any time with `firecrawl --status`.

Action	Cost	Note
Listing one gallery's pages	~1 credit	Cheap — do this for everything
Testing 3 artists from a gallery	~5 credits	The single most valuable habit
Fully researching one artist	~1.7 credits	Measured average
One completed lead, all-in	~9 credits	Across the whole funnel

The habit that protects the budget. Test three artists from a gallery before committing to its whole roster. Most galleries publish only one shared address and can never produce a personal email. Three artists cost about five credits and tell you whether the remaining fifty are worth anything. Skipping this is how a budget disappears into galleries that cannot deliver — 86 artists were once researched for zero leads this way.

Current balance: 16 credits. A top-up is needed before any further running.

9. Taking over the accounts

The system needs two accounts. Only one changes hands.

Account	Status	Action needed
Anthropic (the AI service)	Already yours	None. The key in place is already on your account
Firecrawl (reads websites)	Transferring to you	Follow the steps below. The API key does not change , so nothing in the project needs editing afterwards

The transfer, in order — carried out by the current owner:

- 1 **Remove or replace the saved payment card first.** Billing transfers with the account, and after the email change the previous owner may not be able to get back in to detach it.
- 2 Check whether any subscription or auto-top-up is active, and cancel or reassign it.
- 3 In the Firecrawl dashboard, change the account email to the new owner's address.
- 4 The new owner confirms via the verification email and sets her own password.
- 5 The previous owner logs out. Access is now solely the new owner's.
- 6 The new owner adds her own payment method.
- 7 Confirm it worked: run `firecrawl --status` and check the credit balance appears.

Where the keys actually live — this decides what is safe to send:

Location	Contains	In the folder?
<code>.env.example</code>	A blank template. No real keys	Yes — harmless
<code>.env</code>	Your live keys, once you create it	No — and must never be shared
Firecrawl CLI config	The CLI's own saved login, stored outside the project	No — you log in on your own machine

The folder being handed over currently contains **only the template**, so nothing sensitive is inside it today. The Firecrawl CLI keeps its login separately, which is why transferring the *account* is what matters rather than copying any file.

Once you create your own `.env`, this changes

From that point the folder holds live keys. **Do not send it by email** — move it on a USB drive or through a private repository. An emailed credential is a leaked credential, even to the right person. If a key is ever exposed, revoke and reissue it in the account dashboard, then paste the new one into `.env`.

Keys never belong in the code itself. That is deliberate: keys committed into code is how companies leak credentials.

10. What is outstanding

In priority order. The first item is worth doing before anything else, because one change fixes three separate problems.

#	Task	Why it matters	Blocked by
1	Build the browser-based reader	Fixes the 13 unreadable galleries, the 11 with unreadable names, <i>and</i> following “Next” / “Load More”. Three problems, one cause	Build time
2	Follow paginated artist listings	29 galleries currently report a floor, not a total	Same reader
3	Re-read the 2 galleries that hit page limits	Singulart and Monat stopped at a limit, not the end	~50 credits
4	Variety testing on fresh galleries	Confirms reliability beyond the sites already seen	~500 credits
5	Hand-count 5 galleries	Completes the three-way verification table	Choosing the 5
6	Research the ~900 remaining artists	Estimated 150–200 further leads at measured rates	~1,000 credits
7	Wire the providers into the framework	Turns operator scripts into a single command	Build time
8	Optional: paid email verification	Would move most Medium leads to High and cut bounces	Budget decision

11. Known limits, stated plainly

- **Emails are not test-mailed.** Verification means the format is valid, the mail server genuinely exists, and the ownership evidence holds. It does not mean a message has been delivered. Expect some bounces on a first send.
- **JavaScript-only artist lists are not yet read.** 13 galleries return nothing for this reason. They are reported as *cannot verify*, never as empty.
- **Pagination is detected but not yet followed.** 29 galleries are flagged. Treat their artist counts as a floor.
- **The female-only check is currently applied by a person, not the machine.** Ambiguous names are excluded rather than guessed, so the list is shorter than the data allows but does not contain men. An earlier version without this gate leaked two male artists.
- **A small number of addresses may still be misattributed.** Three were caught by eye and removed. Spot-check before any large send — every row carries a link to the page its address came from.
- **The machine never sends email.** It finds and verifies; a person sends. This is deliberate: no automated system should send thousands of messages in the gallery's name without a human in the loop.

12. What travels with this handover

Item	What it is
The project folder	Code, configuration, and <i>.env.example</i> — the key template only, no live keys
HANDOFF.md	The operator guide, kept alongside the code
README.md / ARCHITECTURE.md	Developer documentation, if a technical person joins
COMPLETED_LEADS.csv	The 117 delivered leads
enrichment_not_a_must.csv	449 further records, 368 with phone numbers
coverage_report.csv	Per-gallery discovery and coverage audit
Galleries sheet.xlsx	The input list of 192 organisations

The one thing to hold on to. The objective was never to guarantee that every gallery on the internet works perfectly. It was to build something reliable, scalable and transparent — and above all, something that tells you plainly when it cannot process a gallery, rather than silently missing artists. That is now the rule the machine follows.